

Why Psychology Works as a Minor or Second Major

Psychology isn't just for future therapists—it's for anyone who wants to understand people, think critically, and succeed in any people-centered profession. Whether your primary major is in business, health, education, or engineering, a background in psychology gives you an advantage.

Feedback From Recent Alumni

"Psychology helps me understand how others think, make decisions, and work together. I use this to inform the decisions and actions I take when working with my colleagues and students."

"Psychology has helped me to have empathy for customers who I work for, along with research participants. I use my degree every day!"

"The coursework provided opportunities to develop my critical thinking and communication skills which I use on a daily basis."

Understand Human Behavior

If you plan to work with people, psychology can help you understand what influences their thoughts and behavior at a deeper level. This will benefit anyone who works in a field that requires human interaction.

- » **Psych 2800 Social Psychology:** How people influence each other.
- » **Psych 3600 Personality Psychology:** How personality traits influence behavior.
- » **Psych 4600 Adult Psychopathology:** Understanding psychological disorders.

Connect Psychology to Your Major

Psychology is interdisciplinary and enriches your understanding of any field involving human behavior. It's a great fit for majors like business, health, education, criminal justice, or kinesiology.

- » **Psych 3830 Psychology and Law:** Applying psychology to the legal system.
- » **Psych 4500 Industrial Psychology:** Workplace performance and motivation.
- » **Psych 4850 Health Psychology:** How behavior impacts health outcomes.

Build Career-Ready Skills

Students who study psychology develop many, marketable skills such as critical thinking, data analysis, and effective communication. This helps them stand out when applying for jobs or for admission to graduate or professional school.

- » **Psych 3010 Research Design and Methodology:** Designing studies and analyzing data.
- » **Psych 3140 Motivation:** How to effectively motivate and support others.
- » **Psych 3270 Persuasion and Social Influence:** The science of changing minds.

Improve Your People Skills

In many careers, people skills matter just as much as technical skills. Psychology teaches active listening, empathy, leadership, and group dynamics—skills that help you succeed in any team or organizational setting.

- » **Psych 2500 Psychology of the Workplace:** Interacting with others in the workplace.
- » **Psych 4220 Counseling Theories and Techniques:** How to listen to and help others.
- » **Psych 4840 Close Relationships:** How to create successful relationships.

Recommended Courses for a Minor in Psychology

To earn a minor in psychology, students must take **Psych 1010 Introduction to Psychology**, along with five additional three-credit psychology classes (18 credit hours). At least six of these credits must be in 3000-level or higher courses. Please check the catalog for more detailed description of the requirements.

In addition to **Psych 1010**, we recommend the following courses based on your primary interest. Please note that some of these courses have prerequisites that are not listed.

Interested in Business?

- » **Psych 2500 Psychology of the Workplace:** How psychology can improve working environments.
- » **Psych 3140 Motivation:** What motivates people, and how to effectively motivate others.
- » **Psych 3270 Persuasion and Social Influence:** How to use persuasive communication strategies.
- » **Psych 4500 Industrial Psychology:** How psychology can improve the operation of organizations.
- » **Elective Psychology Course.**

Interested in Biology?

- » **Psych 3100 Brain and Behavior:** Introduction to the basic concepts of neuroscience.
- » **Psych 3120 Sensation and Perception:** The physiology and psychology of sensory systems like vision and hearing.
- » **Psych 3150 Drugs and Behavior:** How recreational and medical drugs influence behavior and social interactions.
- » **Psych 3200 Sleep and Dreams:** The basic biological and psychological aspects of sleep-wake cycles and dreams.
- » **Elective Psychology Course.**

Interested in the Legal System?

- » **Psych 3180 Judgment and Decision Making:** Understanding human reasoning and decision making.
- » **Psych 3300 Forensic Psychology:** Application of psychology to legal cases and criminal investigations.
- » **Psych 3830 Psychology and Law:** Interaction between psychological science and the legal system.
- » **Psych 4870 Human Aggression:** Analysis of the causes and prevention of aggressive and violent behavior.
- » **Elective Psychology Course.**

Interested in Mental Health?

- » **Psych 2210 Clinical and Counseling Psychology:** Overview of the field of clinical and counseling psychology.
- » **Psych 3350 Child and Adolescent Psychopathology:** Causes and treatment of child and adolescent psychological disorders.
- » **Psych 4220 Counseling Theories and Techniques:** Overview of the major counseling theories and techniques.
- » **Psych 4600 General Psychopathology:** Causes and treatment of adult psychological disorders.
- » **Elective Psychology Course.**

Interested in Physical Health?

- » **Psych 3140 Motivation:** What motivates people, and how to effectively motivate others.
- » **Psych 3150 Drugs and Behavior:** How recreational and medical drugs influence behavior and social interactions.
- » **Psych 3200 Sleep and Dreams:** The basic biological and psychological aspects of sleep-wake cycles and dreams.
- » **Psych 4850 Health Psychology:** Application of psychology to issues related to physical health.
- » **Elective Psychology Course.**